

Pecos County Drilling Activity — Historical & Recent Record

Prepared: 2026-05-19 • **Subject site:** Caramba North tract (≈1,300 ac), Pecos County, TX — centroid ≈ 30.9032° N, 102.9747° W • **Classification:** Confidential

Purpose

This memorandum summarizes the historical and recent record of oil-and-gas drilling — with attention to shallow (<3,000 ft) wells — at and within ten miles of the Caramba North tract, drawn from the Railroad Commission of Texas (RRC) wellbore and drilling-permit records. It is provided as context for evaluating potential ground-vibration considerations for a data-center development on the site.

Throughout, **new drilling (a new wellbore) is distinguished from recompletions (rework of an existing wellbore — no new hole drilled)**; only new drilling involves a drilling rig and the hydraulic-fracturing completion associated with ground vibration.

Proximity is reported at explicit distances from the tract centroid — principally **within two miles** and **within ten miles**. Ten miles is a deliberately generous boundary: ground vibration from drilling and completion attenuates well within that distance.

This report is intended to accompany and utilizes the data underlying the interactive map of Caramba North, which can be accessed through [this link](#).

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Summary of findings

No new drilling is occurring at or near the Caramba North site. Counting only genuine new wells (RRC "New Drill" permits, excluding recompletions): **no well of any kind has been spudded within two miles of the tract in over a decade, no new-drill well lies within five miles, and only three new-drill wells sit within ten miles** across all of 2020–2025 (nearest ≈ 6.9 miles; all three are deep $\geq 9,200$ ft, spud 2020 and 2025).

The wells within two miles are all decades-old legacy completions (drilled 1950s–2002) — mostly plugged shallow verticals plus a handful of long-completed deep wells — **none representing active drilling, hydraulic fracturing, or a vibration source.**

Two further points reinforce this:

Drilling activity in Pecos is mostly recompletions, not new drilling — and the wellbore record is even more skewed than the permit record. Of W-1 permits filed in Pecos since 2020, about **46% are recompletions**. But tracing every Pecos wellbore record actually updated since 2020 (RRC dbf900): **only $\approx 10\%$ (117 of 1,118) are genuine new drilling — the other $\approx 90\%$ are recompletion or workover events on existing wellbores.** A single operator, **Kinder Morgan Production, accounts for 96% of recompletion permits** (reworking existing CO₂-flood fields); workovers use a workover rig on an existing bore, not the drilling-and-fracturing activity at issue, and this program is not near the site.

Genuine new drilling is deep, not shallow — and remote. Pecos saw ≈ 478 New Drill permits since 2020 (vs ≈ 405 recompletion). Tracing those to wells actually spudded, only **116 genuine new wells** exist county-wide, and **$\approx 95\%$ are deep ($\geq 3,000$ ft)** horizontal (Diamondback, XTO, Continental, Gordy); just **six** are shallow. New shallow drilling is therefore nearly nonexistent anywhere in Pecos, and the deep new drilling that does occur is concentrated well away from the tract.

Findings

1. On the Caramba North tract

The shallowest wellbores recorded inside the tract boundary:

Depth (ft)	Spud year	Status	Oil/Gas
2,873	1960	Plugged & abandoned	Gas
3,067	1991	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,109	1957	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,186	1987	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,250	2008	Active	Oil

Only one well on the tract lies below 3,000 ft — a 2,873-ft well spudded in 1960 and long since plugged and abandoned. The only active well on the tract (3,250 ft, spudded 2008) is deeper than 3,000 ft. There has been no shallow (<3,000 ft) drilling on the tract in the modern era.

(The remaining tract records are a single deep 22,545-ft wellbore and permitted-but-undrilled location entries.)

2. Drilling activity in Pecos is mostly recompletions of existing wells — not new drilling

This is the crux of the data, and it is starker in the wellbore record than in the permit record. Two ways of counting Pecos activity since 2020:

Basis of count	Total	Genuine new drilling	Recompletion / workover
W-1 permits filed (intent)	883	478 (54%)	405 (46%)
Wellbore records updated (actual activity)	1,118	117 (≈10%)	1,001 (≈90%)

The permit ratio is what a buyer's technical team will see in any RRC W-1 search — and on that basis **new drilling is still 54% of permit activity**. But tracing the underlying **wellbore record (RRC dbf900)** — where every spud, completion, and re-entry is API-tagged — the genuine-new-drill share collapses to about 10%. The other ≈90% of wellbore-level activity is recompletion or workover events on *existing* wellbores (RRC re-stamps the wellbore's spud date with the recent re-entry event, but the original completion date stays — so completion < spud flags the record as a recompletion).

 Pecos new-drill vs recompletion: permit intent vs. actual wellbore activity

Figure 1. Pecos County since 2020: of 883 W-1 permits, 54% are new-drill intent; but of 1,118 wellbore records actually updated, only ≈10% are genuine new drilling — the rest are recompletion or workover events on existing wells.

96% of recompletion permits — and the bulk of the recompletion events — are by **Kinder Morgan Production** reworking existing CO₂-flood (enhanced-recovery) fields. None of that involves a drilling rig spudding a new hole, none of it involves a new hydraulic-fracturing program, and the program is not near the Caramba North tract.

Whether the question is framed as shallow drilling, hydraulic fracturing, or new drilling of any kind, the record points the same way: **it is not happening at or near this site**.

3. Within 1 mile — no shallow wells

Three wellbores of any depth lie within one mile of the tract; **none is shallow (<3,000 ft)**.

4. Within 2 miles — drilling ended over two decades ago

Of about 46 wellbores within two miles, the ten shallow wells were spudded between 1960 and 2002. The most recent shallow spud within two miles was in 2002, and most of these wells are plugged and abandoned.

No well of any kind — new drill or otherwise — has been spudded within two miles in over a decade.

5. New drilling since 2020, by distance and depth

Counting only genuine new wells (RRC "New Drill" permits — recompletions of existing bores excluded):

Radius	New-drill wells, spudded ≥ 2020
≤ 2 mi	0
≤ 5 mi	0
≤ 10 mi	3 (0 shallow, 3 deep; nearest ≈ 6.9 mi)
> 10 mi	113 (median 20.1 mi, mean 21.1 mi, max 60.4 mi)
County-wide total	116

The three genuine new wells within ten miles, across all of 2020–2025, are 6.9–9.4 miles out and all deep (≈9,200–9,500 ft TD; spudded 2020 and 2025) — none shallow, none within five miles.

The 113 new wells beyond ten miles are at a median distance of **≈ 20 miles** from the tract (max 60 mi). Their depths:

Depth band	Wells (of 113)	Share
< 3,000 ft (shallow)	6	5%
3,000 – 4,999 ft	0	0%
5,000 – 9,999 ft	58	51%
≥ 10,000 ft	49	43%

That is, **107 of 113 (≈95%) of the new wells outside ten miles are deep (≥3,000 ft) — the modern Permian unconventional program** — at a median depth of ≈9,900 ft. The six shallow new-drill wells in the county since 2020 are all remote from the tract.

Even on the *loosest* possible count — every record with a 2020-or-later spud date, including recompletion-restamped records — it is still **zero within two miles** and only ≈23 within ten miles across the whole period. New drilling does not reach the site under any reading of the data.

6. The nearest non-plugged shallow wells are decades-old completions

The nearest non-plugged shallow wells were spudded in 1970 (1.28 mi) and 1988 (1.97 mi) — decades-old completions, not active drilling. A ground-vibration source is an operating drill rig or a hydraulic-fracturing operation; a plugged or long-completed wellbore is not.

No active drilling is occurring adjacent to the tract.

7. County-wide context — new drilling is deep, and remote from the site

Since 2020 the RRC issued roughly **478 New Drill permits** in Pecos County (≈4,700 sq mi), against **≈405 recompletion permits**. Tracing the New Drill permits to wells actually spudded gives **116 genuine new wells county-wide**, about **95% of them deep (≥3,000 ft)** — i.e., the modern Permian horizontal program. Only **three** lie within ten miles of the Caramba North tract, and none within five; the activity is overwhelmingly remote from the site (median 20 miles out — see Finding 5).

8. Pecos vs. peer counties — the least new drilling of the group

On the same genuine-new-drill basis (recompletions excluded), Pecos has dramatically less new drilling than comparable Permian counties. Wells spudded since 2020:

County	New-drill wells since 2020	of which shallow (<3,000 ft)
Pecos (site county)	116	6
Reeves	1,044	35
Midland	1,487	15
Martin	1,616	19
Reagan	629	9
Howard	990	1
Loving	1,121	25
Other-6 average	≈1,148	≈17

Pecos's ≈116 genuine new wells are roughly **one-tenth of the average comparable county's** (≈1,148); Martin, the most active, has ≈1,616, and even the next-lowest comparison county (Reagan) has ≈629. Genuine new shallow drilling is negligible in every county (≤35). On a new-drill basis **Pecos is by far the least-drilled of the seven** — and, per Findings 1–7, essentially none of even that activity is within ten miles of the Caramba North tract.

Howard and Loving counties were pulled from the Railroad Commission's full dbf900 wellbore file and integrated on the same genuine-new-drill basis. They lie outside the six-county sale-area set and well away from the tract; they are included here only to broaden the comparison.

9. Production near the site is decades-old completions — no active drilling or hydraulic-fracturing operations

Every well was additionally cross-referenced against the Railroad Commission's PDQ production records for the most recent six reported months (through May 2026), joined by **API number** through the RRC's authoritative API-to-lease crosswalk — a match covering **≈99.6% of all non-plugged wells**.

A well is treated as "**marginal or end-of-life**" when its lease's trailing-average output is at or below 125 Mcf/day of gas AND at or below 25 bbl/day of oil — a strict marginal-well threshold.

Of the 291 **non-plugged wellbores** within ten miles of the Caramba North tract (recompletion re-stamps already excluded — these are physical wellbores, not paperwork records), **241 (about 83%) are marginal or end-of-life**.

Why so many are end-of-life: most of these wellbores were drilled decades ago and are naturally depleted. The "genuine new drill" filter only removes recompletion re-stamps; it does *not* restrict by spud date. The 291 wellbores within ten miles span the 1960s through 2020s, with the bulk drilled in the 1980s:

Spud decade	Wellbores within 10 mi (non-plugged)
1960s	29
1970s	57
1980s	122
1990s	20
2000s	42
2010s	18
2020s	3

Spud decade of 291 non-plugged wellbores within 10 mi

Figure 2. Of the 291 non-plugged wellbores within 10 mi, 122 were spudded in the 1980s and only 21 since 2010 — most are 35–65 years old, hence the high marginal/end-of-life share.

The 50 still producing above the marginal threshold are not active drilling activity either: they are decades-old completions, in four groups —

- about 15 **legacy deep-gas wells** (mostly 1965–1978 spud, ≈17,000–22,800 ft);
- a cluster of ~31 **low-rate vertical conventional oil wells** at ≈3,150–3,440 ft depth (spud 1986–2012, mostly 2007–2012; all on a unitized lease producing roughly 37.5 bbl/day per well — a stripper-grade pumping operation);
- 3 **truly shallow (<3,000 ft) oil wells** at 2,824–2,945 ft (spud 2004–2011, also at stripper rates just above the threshold); and
- the single **2020 deep-horizontal new-drill** noted in Finding 5 (9,237 ft, 9.37 mi out).

Production status of 291 non-plugged wellbores within 10 mi

Figure 3. Production status of 291 non-plugged wellbores within 10 mi: 83% marginal or end-of-life, 17% still producing — all on decades-old completions.

Within five miles, **52 of 86 non-plugged wellbores are marginal or end-of-life** and the 34 still producing are 3 of the legacy deep-gas wells plus 31 of the shallow vertical oil cluster — none from the modern Permian horizontal program.

Within two miles, **3 of 5 non-plugged wellbores are marginal or end-of-life** and the 2 still producing are the 1.13-mi 1975/≈22,100-ft legacy gas well (125.7 Mcf/d) and a 1.97-mi 2008/≈3,275-ft vertical oil well (37.5 bbl/d).

A pumping wellhead or low-rate gas well on a decades-old completion is not a drill rig or a hydraulic-fracturing spread; together with the plugged legacy wells discussed above, **there is no active drilling or hydraulic-fracturing operation at or near the site.**

County-wide, of the ≈35,100 non-plugged wellbores in the six sale-area counties, ≈12,540 are plugged, ≈12,490 are marginal or end-of-life by this measure, and ≈10,060 are still producing above the threshold. The API-to-lease crosswalk matches ≈99.6% of non-plugged wells; the ≈90 that do not match are conservatively left classified "Active." Production filings carry a normal reporting lag, which the six-month trailing window mitigates.

10. What the data can and can't tell us about hydraulic fracturing

RRC's standard wellbore (dbf900) and W-1 permit files record well depth, profile (vertical, directional, or horizontal), spud and completion dates, and permit type — but they do **not** directly disclose whether a well was hydraulically fractured at completion. The authoritative public record of fracking jobs is the Texas FracFocus disclosure database ([fracfocus.org](https://www.fracfocus.org)), which operators must file post-frac since 2012; pre-2012 frack jobs are not centrally archived in a single source.

That said, the near-site well groups can be classified with high confidence from the RRC data alone, given depth, profile, and era:

Well group near the site	Within 10 mi	Hydraulically fractured?
Modern Permian horizontal (deep, spud ≥ 2010)	1 (9.37 mi, 2020)	Yes — essentially all stimulated
Conventional vertical oil at ≈3,000–3,500 ft (1980s–2010s)	~31 still producing	No — pumped, not fractured

Truly shallow (<3,000 ft) vertical oil (1980s–2010s)	~3 still producing	No
Legacy deep gas at 17,000–22,800 ft (1960s–70s)	~15 still producing	Possibly acid-stimulated at original completion; not now

The one well near the site that is almost certainly fracked — the 9.37-mi, 2020, 9,237-ft deep-horizontal — is not within five miles, is now five years past completion, and is no longer in the hydraulic-fracturing phase. **No active hydraulic-fracturing operation is occurring at or near the Caramba North tract — neither on horizontal wellbores nor on vertical wellbores.**